

PAST CONTINUOUS TENSE

Trainer

IMAM

Past continuous Tense Formation

In Arabic, the past continuous tense is usually expressed using the past tense of the verb along with an auxiliary verb like كانkān, meaning "was" to indicate continuity.

This structure helps convey an ongoing action in the past, similar to "was/were + verb-ing" in English.

The verb كانchanges according to the subject

Structure:
Kān + present tense verb
كان+ المضارع

Past Tense Conjugation Of "كان" (kān)

كان	Huwa	Kān	He was
كانوا	Hum	Kānu	They were (M-P)
كانت	Hiya	Kānat	She was
كنت	Inth	Kint	You were
كنتوا	Intū	Kintu	You were (M-P)
كنت	Intē	Kinti	You were (F)
كنت	Ana	Kint	I was
كنا	Nahn	kunna	We were

Past + Present Tense Conjugation

ஹுவ	கான்	யிஷ்ரப்	He was drinking
ஹும்	கானூ	யிஷ்ரபூன்	They were drinking
ஹிய	கானத்	திஷ்ரப்	She was drinking
இன்த்	கின்த்	திஷ்ரப்	You were drinking
இன்தூ	கின்தூ	திஷ்ரபூன்	You were drinking
இன்தீ	கின்தீ	திஷ்ரபீன்	You were drinking
அன	கின்த்	அஷ்ரப்	I was drinking
நஹ்ன்	குன்னா	நிஷ்ரப்	We were drinking

Examples

I was drinking coffee. → كنت أشرب قهوة.
(Kint ashrab gahwa)

She was drinking tea → كانت تشرب شاي.
(Kānat tishrab shāy)

They were drinking juice. → كانوا يشربون عصير. (Kānu yishrabūn ʿaṣīr)

We were drinking water. → كنا نشرب ماي.
(Kunna nishrab māy)

Examples

I was eating lunch.
كنت آكل الغداء.
(Kint akil al-ghada)

She was talking on the phone.
كانت تتكلم في التلفون.
(Kānat titkallam fi at-tilifoon.)

They were watching TV.
كانوا يشوفون التلفزيون.
(Kānū yishūfūn at-tilifizyon.)

PRACTICE TIME

1. I was working in the office yesterday.

2. We were talking about politics. (as-siyāsa)

3. He was searching for a job in the Gulf (yidawwir)

4. She was cooking lunch in the kitchen

Answer

1. Kint ashtighil fil-maktab ams
كِنت أشتغل في المكتب أمس

2. Kunna nitkallam ‘an as-siyāsah
كنّا نتكلم عن السّياسة

3. kān yidawwir shughl fil-khaleej
كان يدور شغل في الخليج

4. hiyya kānat tiṭbikh el-ghada fil-maṭbakh
هي كانت تطبخ الغدا في المطبخ

كان+ Noun

كان+ noun is used to describe past states, conditions, or identities

I was happy – (Kint farḥān) – كنت فرحان

She was tired – (Kānat taʿbāna) كانت تعبانة

We were married – (Kunna mitzawwajīn) كنا متزوجين

He was sleeping – (Kān nayim) كان نايم

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